

TattooTalks Premium Design System

“Molten Gold” - World-Class Luxury Aesthetic

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Color Palette

Base Backgrounds (No Pure Black)

```
--ink-primary: #121212    /* Primary Background (Cod Gray) */
--ink-surface: #1A1A1A    /* Cards/Surfaces (Deep Charcoal) */
--ink-deep: #0D0D0D       /* Deepest shadows */
```

Usage in Tailwind:

```
<div className="bg-ink-primary">           {/* Primary background */}
<div className="bg-ink-surface">           {/* Card surfaces */}
<div className="bg-ink-deep">              {/* Deep shadows */}
```

Molten Gold Accent (Brand Signature)

```
--molten-gold: #C5A059    /* Old Gold / Metallic (Gradient Start) */
--molten-amber: #CC5500   /* Burnt Amber / Fire (Gradient End) */
```

Usage in Tailwind:

```
<div className="text-molten-gold">         {/* Gold text */}
<div className="border-molten-amber">       {/* Amber border */}
<div className="bg-molten-gold">           {/* Solid gold background */}
```

Gradient Usage:

```
<div className="bg-gradient-to-r from-molten-gold to-molten-amber">
  Molten Gold Gradient
</div>
```

Text Hierarchy

```
--text-primary: #F5F5F5 /* Off-White (softer than pure white) */
--text-secondary: #A3A3A3 /* Neutral Gray */
--text-muted: #737373 /* Dimmed text */
```

Usage in Tailwind:

```
<h1 className="text-text-primary">Main Heading</h1>
<p className="text-text-secondary">Secondary text</p>
<span className="text-text-muted">Muted caption</span>
```

Typography

Font Families

Serif for Headings (Editorial & Classy)

- **Primary:** Playfair Display
- **Alternative:** Cinzel
- **Vibe:** Elegant, traditional, artistic (like Vogue, Inked Mag)

```
<h1 className="font-serif text-5xl font-bold">
  Premium Heading
</h1>

<h2 className="font-cinzel text-3xl font-semibold">
  Alternative Heading
</h2>
```

Sans-Serif for Body/UI (Clean & Geometric)

- **Primary:** Inter
- **Vibe:** Invisible, functional, modern

```
<p className="font-sans text-base">
  Body text with excellent readability on mobile.
</p>

<button className="font-sans font-semibold uppercase tracking-wide">
  Action Button
</button>
```

Typography Scale

```
/* Headings (use font-serif) */
<h1 className="font-serif text-6xl font-bold">Hero Title</h1>
<h2 className="font-serif text-5xl font-bold">Section Title</h2>
<h3 className="font-serif text-4xl font-semibold">Subsection</h3>
<h4 className="font-serif text-3xl font-semibold">Card Title</h4>

/* Body (use font-sans) */
<p className="font-sans text-lg">Large body text</p>
<p className="font-sans text-base">Regular body text</p>
<p className="font-sans text-sm">Small text</p>
<p className="font-sans text-xs">Captions</p>
```

CSS Utility Classes

1. Gold Gradient Text

Basic Gradient Text:

```
<h1 className="gold-gradient-text text-5xl font-serif">
  Molten Gold Heading
</h1>
```

Animated Shimmer Text:

```
<h1 className="gold-gradient-text-shimmer text-5xl font-serif">
  Premium Shimmer Effect
</h1>
```

CSS Classes:

```
.gold-gradient-text {
  background: linear-gradient(135deg, #C5A059 0%, #CC5500 100%);
  -webkit-background-clip: text;
  -webkit-text-fill-color: transparent;
  background-clip: text;
  font-weight: 700;
}

.gold-gradient-text-shimmer {
  /* Same as above + animated shimmer */
  animation: shimmer 3s linear infinite;
}
```

2. Gold Border Glow

Standard Glow (for buttons, cards):

```
<button className="gold-border-glow px-8 py-4 rounded-lg">
  Premium Button
</button>
```

Strong Glow (for hero CTAs, avatars):

```
<div className="gold-border-glow-strong rounded-full p-1">
  
</div>
```

CSS Classes:

```
.gold-border-glow {
  border: 1.5px solid transparent;
  background-origin: border-box;
  background-clip: padding-box, border-box;
  background-image:
    linear-gradient(var(--ink-surface), var(--ink-surface)),
    linear-gradient(135deg, var(--molten-gold), var(--molten-amber));
  box-shadow:
    0 0 20px rgba(197, 160, 89, 0.3),
    inset 0 0 12px rgba(197, 160, 89, 0.1);
  transition: all 0.3s;
}

.gold-border-glow:hover {
  box-shadow:
    0 0 32px rgba(197, 160, 89, 0.5),
    inset 0 0 16px rgba(197, 160, 89, 0.15);
  transform: translateY(-2px);
}
```

3. Premium Card Effects

```
<div className="card-premium p-6">
  <h3 className="font-serif text-2xl mb-4">Card Title</h3>
  <p className="font-sans text-text-secondary">Card content...</p>
</div>
```

CSS Class:

```
.card-premium {
  background: var(--ink-surface);
  border: 1px solid var(--border-subtle);
  border-radius: var(--radius);
  transition: all 0.3s;
}

.card-premium:hover {
  transform: translateY(-4px);
  border-color: rgba(197, 160, 89, 0.3);
  box-shadow:
    0 8px 32px rgba(0, 0, 0, 0.4),
    0 0 16px rgba(197, 160, 89, 0.15);
}
```

4. Premium Icon Styling (Outline Style, 1.5px Stroke)

```
import { Heart } from 'lucide-react'

<Heart className="icon-premium h-6 w-6" />
<Heart className="icon-premium active h-6 w-6" /> { /* Active state */ }
```

CSS Class:

```
.icon-premium {
  stroke-width: 1.5px;
  color: var(--text-secondary);
  transition: all 0.3s;
}

.icon-premium:hover,
.icon-premium.active {
  background: linear-gradient(135deg, var(--molten-gold), var(--molten-amber));
  -webkit-background-clip: text;
  -webkit-text-fill-color: transparent;
  filter: drop-shadow(0 0 8px rgba(197, 160, 89, 0.4));
}
```

Component Examples

Premium Action Button (Full Example)

```
import { PremiumButton } from '@components/ui/premium-button'
import { ArrowRight } from 'lucide-react'

export function HeroCTA() {
  return (
    <div className="space-y-4">
      {/* Primary CTA with strong glow */}
      <PremiumButton
        variant="primary"
        size="lg"
        glow="strong"
        className="group"
      >
        Get Started
        <ArrowRight className="h-5 w-5 group-hover:translate-x-1 transition-trans-
form" />
      </PremiumButton>

      {/* Secondary button with outline */}
      <PremiumButton
        variant="outline"
        size="md"
        glow="medium"
      >
        Learn More
      </PremiumButton>

      {/* Loading state */}
      <PremiumButton
        variant="primary"
        size="md"
        isLoading
      >
        Processing...
      </PremiumButton>

      {/* Shimmer effect */}
      <PremiumButton
        variant="primary"
        size="xl"
        shimmer
      >
        Premium Upgrade
      </PremiumButton>
    </div>
  )
}
```

Premium Card Component

```
export function PremiumCard() {
  return (
    <div className="card-premium p-8 space-y-4">
      {/* Gold gradient heading */}
      <h3 className="gold-gradient-text text-3xl font-serif">
        Premium Feature
      </h3>

      {/* Body text */}
      <p className="text-text-secondary font-sans text-base leading-relaxed">
        Experience world-class design with our molten gold aesthetic.
      </p>

      {/* Premium button */}
      <PremiumButton variant="outline" size="sm">
        Explore
      </PremiumButton>
    </div>
  )
}
```

Premium Avatar with Glow

```
import Image from 'next/image'

export function PremiumAvatar({ src }: { src: string }) {
  return (
    <div className="gold-border-glow-strong rounded-full p-1 inline-block">
      <div className="relative w-24 h-24 rounded-full overflow-hidden">
        <Image
          src={src}
          alt="Premium Avatar"
          fill
          className="object-cover"
        />
      </div>
    </div>
  )
}
```

Premium Hero Section

```
export function HeroSection() {
  return (
    <section className="relative min-h-screen bg-ink-deep flex items-center justify-center">
      {/* Subtle glow background */}
      <div className="absolute inset-0 bg-molten-glow opacity-30" />

      <div className="relative z-10 text-center space-y-8 px-4">
        {/* Serif heading with shimmer */}
        <h1 className="gold-gradient-text-shimmer text-7xl md:text-8xl font-serif font-bold">
          TattooTalks
        </h1>

        {/* Secondary heading */}
        <p className="text-text-primary text-2xl md:text-3xl font-sans font-light">
          World-Class Tattoo Community
        </p>

        {/* Premium CTA */}
        <PremiumButton
          variant="primary"
          size="xl"
          glow="strong"
          className="mt-8"
        >
          Join the Elite
        </PremiumButton>
      </div>
    </section>
  )
}
```



Best Practices

Do's

1. Typography Hierarchy:

- Use `font-serif` (Playfair Display) for H1-H4
- Use `font-sans` (Inter) for body text, buttons, UI elements
- Always pair with proper font weights (700+ for headings)

2. Gold Gradient Usage:

- Apply to **key brand elements only** (logo, CTA text, premium badges)
- Use `gold-gradient-text-shimmer` sparingly (hero sections only)
- Avoid gradients on small text (<14px)

3. Glow Effects:

- Use `gold-border-glow` for interactive elements (buttons, cards)
- Use `gold-border-glow-strong` for hero CTAs and avatars
- Always combine with hover transitions

4. Icon Styling:

- Set `stroke-width: 1.5px` on all Lucide icons
- Default color: `text-secondary` (`#A3A3A3`)
- Active state: Apply `icon-premium active` class

5. Background Colors:

- **Never use pure black (`#000000`)**
- Use `bg-ink-primary` (`#121212`) for main backgrounds
- Use `bg-ink-surface` (`#1A1A1A`) for cards/surfaces
- Use `bg-ink-deep` (`#0D0D0D`) for deep shadows only

Don'ts ❌

1. Avoid Flat Colors:

- Don't use solid yellow/orange (`#FFC93C`, `#FFB800`)
- Always use gradients for gold accents

2. Don't Overuse Glow:

- Limit glow effects to 2-3 elements per screen
- Avoid glow on body text or small UI elements

3. Typography Mistakes:

- Don't use serif fonts for buttons or form inputs
- Don't use sans-serif for main headings (H1-H2)
- Don't mix multiple serif fonts on the same page

4. Icon Mistakes:

- Avoid filled icons (always use outline style)
- Don't use `stroke-width > 2px` (too bold)
- Don't use bright colors by default (stick to gray)



Quick Start Checklist

- [] Import Google Fonts (Playfair Display, Inter, Cinzel)
- [] Replace all `bg-black` with `bg-ink-primary`
- [] Update headings to use `font-serif`
- [] Apply `gold-gradient-text` to logo and main headings
- [] Add `gold-border-glow` to primary CTAs
- [] Update icons to use `icon-premium` class
- [] Replace flat yellow (`#FFC93C`) with `molten-gold` gradient
- [] Test hover states on all interactive elements



Resources

• Fonts:

- [Playfair Display](https://fonts.google.com/specimen/Playfair+Display) (<https://fonts.google.com/specimen/Playfair+Display>)
- [Inter](https://fonts.google.com/specimen/Inter) (<https://fonts.google.com/specimen/Inter>)
- [Cinzel](https://fonts.google.com/specimen/Cinzel) (<https://fonts.google.com/specimen/Cinzel>)

- **Color Reference:**

- Molten Gold: #C5A059
- Burnt Amber: #CC5500
- Cod Gray: #121212

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